Robert Straubmüller

Co-founder, Levelwork · UX research, design and AI engineering · Konstanz, Germany

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Robert grew up helping in the family restaurant from age 12 and has designed from the guest's side ever since. From 2014, alongside design school, Robert assisted advertising photographers in Munich and Stuttgart, organising and running large commercial shoots, and from 2017 ran a freelance design practice, including the visual identity of the women's handball team FRISCH AUF Göppingen from 2017 to 2022. Then came UX: leading the UX team on an award-winning exhibition, senior UX work at a design agency, turning simulation maths into a product at a research institute, and retraining full time in AI engineering. Since 2026 Robert has been building Levelwork full time as co-founder.

EXPERIENCE

2026–	**Co-founder**, Levelwork, Konstanz Full time. Building Constat with Michael Gajda.
2026–	**Freelance UX and AI**, gyv AI meeting minutes for council meetings, in pilot at a district administration.
2022–25	**UX Researcher / UI Designer**, Institute for Optical Systems, HTWG Konstanz Half-time position. Flowculate: concept, UI, brand and project management; led up to four student developers.
2024–25	**Design consultant, freelance**, Cluster of Excellence "The Politics of Inequality", University of Konstanz Visual and narrative design of the Excellence Strategy renewal application.
2022–24	**UX Designer, Senior UX Designer from 2024**, user generated design GmbH, Konstanz Employed in 2022, freelance from October 2022. Tealucent design system for goconut; clients included Migros and Sto.
2020–23	**UX/UI and brand designer, freelance**, Stadtmuseum Tettnang Project lead for a new corporate identity, website and digital collection interface, with the University of Konstanz.
2019–20	**Junior Art Director**, Siegelwerk GmbH, Stuttgart Design agency.
2017–	**Freelance design practice**, Own practice Brand and editorial design, including the visual identity of FRISCH AUF Göppingen's women's handball team, 2017–22.

2014–20	**Freelance photo assistant**, Conny Stein Photodesign, Munich · Udo Schönewald, Stuttgart Advertising, product, portrait and industrial photography; helped organise and run large commercial shoots.
2014–20	**Freelance design and set styling**, Tanja Fritz, Ebersbach · Christine Oesterle Design work for the agency; styling and props for photo shoots.

EDUCATION

2025–26	**AI Engineering**, neue fische, Berlin Full-time bootcamp: data science, machine learning, LLM applications. Capstone: SayFit.
2022–23	**Guest student, Business Informatics**, HTWG Konstanz Programming, software engineering, web technologies.
2021–24	**International Leadership Development Program**, HTWG Konstanz Scholarship, two cohorts. Met leaders from public broadcasting, sport, politics and industry in Berlin and Hamburg.
2020–22	**M.A. Communication Design**, HTWG Konstanz and University of Konstanz Thesis: Conactive, interaction with connected systems.
2018	**Erasmus semester**, Lahti University of Applied Sciences, Finland
2015–19	**B.A. Communication Design**, HfG Schwäbisch Gmünd Thesis: Hello, a guide for young designers on presenting their work, as a book and a website.

AWARDS

2022	**Konstanz Design Award, 1st prize**, Master's thesis Conactive
2022	**Red Dot: Junior Award, Exhibition Design**, Stayin' Alive, project team
2022	**ADC Talent Award, Gold, Exhibition**, Stayin' Alive, project team
2021	**CommAwards, Gold, Space**, Stayin' Alive, project team

LANGUAGES

German, native · English, fluent (LCCI Level 2) · French, basic

Case studies and all projects: straubmueller.com · Updated October 2026